

USP OF SUPER SPECIALTY HOSPITAL

DIABETIC RETINOPATHY

Retina Group Shroff Eye Centre

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What is Diabetic retinopathy?

When the retina is affected by diabetes, weakened blood vessels may leak fluid or blood, causing damage to the retina. This is called DIABETIC RETINOPATHY. There are two forms of diabetic retinopathy. In BACKGROUND RETINOPATHY, blood vessels within the retina become abnormally permeable and allow substances like fluid and lipid to leak out. The second form is PROLIFERATIVE RETINOPATHY. Abnormal fragile 'new' blood vessels grow on the surface of the retina or optic nerve and sometimes into the vitreous cavity. These fragile vessels may rupture and bleed into the normally clear vitreous gel, blocking light from reaching the retina.

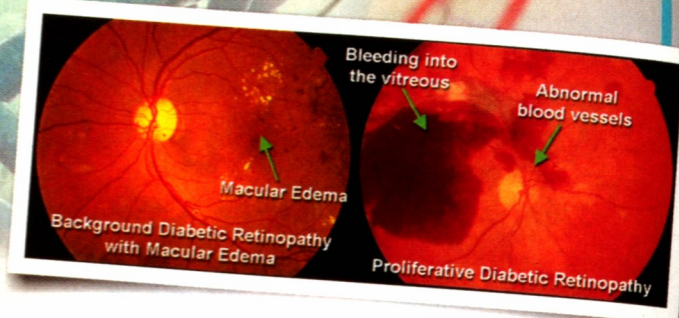
What are the Symptoms of Diabetic Retinopathy?

An eye with marked changes of Diabetic Retinopathy can have good vision and may be totally free of symptoms. Hence it is important for all diabetics to undergo REGULAR EYE CHECK-UP INCLUDING RETINAL EXAMINATION.

Reduced central vision can occur if the macula gets edematous (swollen). Black spots (floaters) and cobwebs of sudden onset often point to a minor bleed inside the eye. Sudden total loss of vision may occur due to a large bleed into the vitreous. Hence, all diabetics need to be aware that diabetic retinopathy is a sight threatening disease.

How is Diabetic Retinopathy Managed?

If diabetic retinopathy is noted, color photographs of the retina may be taken and FLUORESCIN ANGIOGRAPHY performed. This involves dilating the pupils and injection of a fluorescent dye into a vein in the arm. Photographs of the retina are taken rapidly as the dye passes through the retinal blood vessels.



OPTICAL COHERENCE TOMOGRAPHY (OCT), which is a newer non-invasive diagnostic modality, provides a cross-sectional view of the retina and helps in quantifying the amount and type of swelling and guides the treatment.

PHOTOCOAGULATION involves the use of a LASER beam to seal leaking blood vessels and prevent growth of abnormal blood vessels. Laser treatment significantly reduces the chances of severe visual loss by destroying the abnormal blood vessels and preventing growth of more such vessels.

Recently, along with laser treatment, certain medications including anti-VEGF agents and steroids when injected into the eye or around the eye have shown encouraging results.

If the vitreous is too clouded with blood or there is traction retinal detachment, laser treatment will not work. In this situation, a surgical procedure called VITRECTOMY needs to be performed. In this operation, opaque vitreous gel is removed from within the eye by a special instrument that simultaneously sucks and cuts the vitreous.

LOSS OF VISION FROM DIABETIC RETINOPATHY IS LARGELY PREVENTABLE

EARLY DETECTION of diabetic retinopathy is the best protection against sight loss. This is possible by having a complete eye examination including retina check-up once a year or more frequently if advised. In most cases the ophthalmologist can then begin treatment before sight is affected.

SIR GANGA RAM HOSPITAL : A BRIEF PROFILE

Originally established in 1921 by Sir Ganga Ram in Lahore (Pakistan) and later re-established by Late Shri Dharma Vira, ICS at Delhi in 1954, Sir Ganga Ram Hospital is a leading tertiary care not for profit Trust Hospital. Its phenomenal success is credited to the unique functioning, wisdom and foresight of the Boards of Management.

Dr. B. K. Rao is the Chairman of the present Board of Management, who has been a Consultant in Sir Ganga Ram Hospital for more than 20 years and is presently the Chairman of the Department of Critical Care Medicine and Emergency. Padma Bhushan Awardee Dr. Rao is also the Chairman of the Expert Committee on Health of ASSOCHAM. Under his chairmanship, the hospital has received many Awards and Honors, prominent among which are the 'Overall Best Hospital of 2008 – Non Corporate', from Express Healthcare Excellence and Asia Hospital Management Award in 2006 from Mr. Heng Chee How, Minister of State for Health, Government of Singapore.

Sir Ganga Ram is accredited by the (NABH), (NABL), and Quality Management Systems as per ISO 9001: 2000, Environment Management Systems as per ISO 14001: 2004 and Occupational Health and Safety Management Systems as per OHSAS 18001: 1999.

This 650 bedded hospital runs at 95–100% occupancy at all times, caters to nearly 4 lac out patients and over 50,000 in patients annually. With modular operation theatres, the hospital performs about 18,000 surgeries every year.

20% of the hospital beds are reserved for the free treatment of poor patients. The hospital conducts free medical camps and spends more than Rs. 15 Crores for free services.

The Department of Academics attracts the best students from all over the country.

It is the Centre for the Basic and Clinical Sciences Examination in India for International Council of Ophthalmology. Royal College of Surgeons and Physicians, Glasgow conduct FRCS Part – A and B examinations for Ophthalmology here. The department has initiated Teleducation to share the academic programmes and live surgery transmission with other institutions.

Sir Ganga Ram Hospital has developed a relevant approach of Telemedicine by tying up with the Departments of Science, Space (ISRO), Information & Technology and Health & Family Welfare, Government of India. The hospital has established telelinks with remote villages in Haryana, Rajasthan and Himachal Pradesh.

The hospital is recognized as a Research Institute by the Department of Scientific and Industrial Research, Government of India and is an approved Centre by Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, New Delhi for conducting Research for award of the Degree of Doctor of Philosophy.

Amongst its regular clientele are many public figures like the Prime Minister, Chief Ministers, Governors and senior politicians, CEOs of multinationals, sports and media personalities and even from time to time, the first citizen of the country.

The hospital has lived up to the image and goodwill it has earned entirely due to the trust it has acquired over the last fifty years

